

JAMES VARGAS

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

18 years in DevOps/Infrastructure, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: Bash and Kafka.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Stonebridge IT — Cloud Engineer

December 2011 to April 2026

- Designed the multi-region failover strategy and led the game-day exercises that proved it.
- Migrated 10 services to Datadog, cutting monthly infrastructure spend by 25%.
- Introduced infrastructure-as-code with Linux, eliminating manual provisioning entirely.
- Led the Kubernetes upgrade across 5 clusters with zero customer-visible downtime.
- Hardened CI/CD environments ahead of SOC 2, closing 50 critical findings.

Platform Engineer, Nova Tech Group

September 2009 to October 2011

- Reduced incident MTTR from 4 hours to under 90 minutes with better alert routing and runbooks.
- Built observability on Datadog so teams could self-serve dashboards instead of filing tickets.
- Introduced secret rotation and least-privilege IAM across 20 accounts.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions, bringing mean time to deploy under 4 minutes.

Infrastructure Engineer, Snowflake

March 2007 to August 2009

- Wrote the platform team's paved-road documentation, cutting onboarding from weeks to days.
- Cut container image sizes by 20%, shortening cold starts across the fleet.
- Ran the on-call rotation for 8 production services, sustaining 99.9% availability.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

Bachelor, Software Engineering

Northgate University | 2006

TECH STACK

Bash — Expert
Kafka — Working knowledge
CI/CD — Expert
Linux — Expert
Nginx — Expert
GitHub Actions — Expert
GCP — Expert
Azure — Expert
Datadog — Advanced
Docker — Expert
Go — Expert
Spark — Expert

Cypress — Proficient
Sketch — Expert
MongoDB — Expert
Elasticsearch — Working knowledge

PROJECTS

Technical blog

Writing up Elasticsearch experiments and failures, roughly 8k readers a month.

Conference talk

Spoke on Kafka in production at a regional meetup, ~50 attendees.

CERTIFICATIONS

ISTQB Certified Tester - Foundation Level — ISTQB, 2020

ACHIEVEMENTS

Internal Hackathon Winner, 2026

Peer Recognition Award, 2026

INTERESTS

Woodworking, Competitive pub quizzes, Bouldering